I manage to drive the ball through the covers to the boundary. That feels OK. Next ball, he bowls shorter and still a little too wide. I manage to rock back and cut the ball for four behind square wicket. In a moment of youthful innocence, I think to myself: 'Is this really Test cricket? Batting against the No. 1 bowler in the world? It's got to be tougher than this.'

Jacques and I take the score to 63 for one in the 16th over. I am facing Andrew Flintoff and the sixth ball of the over nips back and clatters into my pad. English voices scream in unison for LBW and, as my heart sinks, umpire Simon Taufel raises his finger. Wasn't it going high? I think it was, but that doesn't count for much. I am out for 28.

The Test flashes past. We eventually make 337 in our first innings, but England respond well and reach 238 for one when Andrew Strauss, on 126, executes a powerful square cut. The ball is coming straight at me, but I manage to hold the catch.

I am working hard in the field, chasing everything, diving at every opportunity, sprinting between overs to fetch a cap from the bowler and take it to the umpire, chattering, encouraging my teammates. Someone says I am fielding like Jonty Rhodes. Somebody actually says that! There is no greater compliment. All these years after that humiliating afternoon in the garden at 20 Mentz Avenue, when I was told to remove my Jonty cap because I didn't deserve to wear it, maybe I have earned the right.

We are playing under constant pressure. I score 14 in the second innings, and we are dismissed for 229. Set only 142 to win, England ease to victory for the loss of only three wickets.

The second Test starts on Boxing Day at Kingsmead in Durban, and I am told that (a) I will be keeping wicket, and (b) I will be dropped down the order to bat at No. 7. No problem – I do as I'm told. Whatever is good for the team is good for me, and if that's what the selectors say, that's how it will be. I enjoy keeping wicket because it keeps me busy.

We bowl out England for 139 and Jacques Kallis scores a classy 162 in our first innings of 332, but England respond well in their second innings